



INNOVATION WEEK TANZANIA 2026



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INTRODUCTION

Innovation and technology are important drivers of economic and social development in today's world. The rapid development of artificial intelligence, software systems, digital platforms, automation, robotics, digital manufacturing, and other emerging technologies has created new opportunities for solving problems in different sectors.

Innovation Week Tanzania 2026 provided an opportunity to interact with innovators, entrepreneurs, technology companies, students, researchers, institutions and other stakeholders within Tanzania's innovation ecosystem.

The experience provided practical exposure to how technology is developed and applied to solve real-world problems. It also helped me understand the relationship between academic knowledge and its practical application in the industry.

BACKGROUND OF INNOVATION WEEK TANZANIA

Innovation Week Tanzania (IWTz) is a national innovation platform that brings together innovators, entrepreneurs, researchers, policymakers, investors, private-sector organizations, development partners, young people and other stakeholders within Tanzania's innovation ecosystem. The platform was established in 2015 and has developed into an important national platform for showcasing innovation, encouraging collaboration, addressing challenges affecting innovation and supporting the development and scaling of Tanzanian solutions.

The platform also recognizes the importance of youth, entrepreneurship, research, digital transformation, and cross-sector collaboration in creating new opportunities and accelerating national development.

OVERVIEW OF INNOVATION WEEK TANZANIA 2026

Innovation Week Tanzania 2026 was the **12th edition** of the platform and was held from **31 August to 4 September 2026** at the **Julius Nyerere International Convention Centre (JNICC), Dar es Salaam**. The five-day event brought together innovators, entrepreneurs, technology companies, researchers, investors, policymakers and other stakeholders to exchange knowledge, showcase innovations, and explore opportunities for collaboration.

The **2026 edition** was guided by the theme “**From Aspirations to Transformation: Innovating Tanzania’s Path to Inclusive Prosperity.**” The theme emphasized the importance of transforming ideas, innovation, and national aspirations into practical solutions that contribute to inclusive economic and social development. It also reflected Tanzania’s efforts to implement **Dira 2050 (Tanzania Development Vision 2050)**, with innovation, technology, research and digital transformation playing an important role in the country’s development.



ACTIVITIES AND LEARNING

POINTS OF FOCUS ON EACH DAY

- **Day 1:** Tanzania is aiming for a USD 1 trillion economy by 2050 under Dira 2050, and the room made one thing clear, we won't get there by doing what we've always done.
- **Day 2:** Turning ideas into systems, the platforms, capital, regulation and skills that carry innovation from vision to action.

- **Day 3:** "Systems for Scale," exploring how we can build lasting infrastructure, regulations, and execution capability to take Tanzanian innovations to the next level.
- **Day 4:** Explored capital, health and skills, looking at ways to unlock local investment, build AI readiness and promote inclusive innovation as Tanzania moves toward Vision 2050.
- **Day 5:** Focusing on fintech growth, cybersecurity threats, practical startup operations, and celebrating major ecosystem milestones as Tanzania builds toward Vision 2050

TECHNOLOGY & INNOVATION

COMPANY EXPOSURES

NEUROTECH

Neurotech is a Tanzanian technology company that develops artificial intelligence and digital solutions to address business and communication needs. The company works with technologies such as conversational AI, voice technology, digital commerce, APIs, and payment systems.

During our visit, we were introduced to how artificial intelligence can be integrated into digital platforms to automate communication, respond to customers, and improve business operations. The experience helped us understand the practical application of AI and how software systems can be connected through APIs to provide different services.

EKIMA INTERACTIVE

Ekima Interactive is a Tanzanian education technology (EdTech) company that develops digital solutions aimed at improving the learning experience. Its technologies include interactive learning content, digital platforms, AI, multimedia, and learning management systems.

During the visit, we learned how technology can be used to make education more engaging through interactive materials, simulations and digital resources. We also gained an understanding of how digital platforms can collect learning information and provide insights that can help improve educational outcomes.

VESTIS TECH

Vestis Tech is a Tanzanian fashion technology and e-commerce platform that uses digital technology to connect fashion businesses with customers. The platform provides an online environment where fashion products can be presented and purchased while using modern technologies to improve customer experience.

During our visit, we learned how software can transform traditional businesses by moving their services to digital platforms. We also gained exposure to technologies such as online commerce and virtual try-on, demonstrating how technology can make online shopping more interactive and convenient.

SARATANI.AI

Saratani.AI is a technology initiative that focuses on applying artificial intelligence to cancer-related information and healthcare challenges. The organization demonstrates how AI can be used to provide useful information and support in the healthcare sector.

During our exposure, we learned that artificial intelligence has applications beyond business and entertainment and can also contribute to solving important social and healthcare problems. The experience also highlighted the importance of accuracy, data quality, privacy, and ethical considerations when developing technology for healthcare.

SWAHILI D-MAKERS

Swahili D-Makers is a Tanzanian digital fabrication and 3D-printing company involved in 3D printer development, computer-aided design, prototyping, manufacturing and technology training.

During our visit, we learned how a digital design can be transformed into a physical object using a 3D printer. We were introduced to the relationship between software, computer-aided design, and hardware manufacturing. The experience demonstrated how 3D printing can be used for prototyping, education, innovation and product development, while also showing the connection between computer engineering and modern manufacturing.

INNOVATIONS OBSERVED

Throughout Innovation Week, I was exposed to several areas of technology.

- Artificial Intelligence (AI)
- Software Development
- APIs
- Digital Learning
- E-Commerce
- 3D Printing and Digital Fabrication.
- Data and Insights

KNOWLEDGE AND SKILLS ACQUIRED

- **Technical Knowledge;** I improved my understanding of Artificial Intelligence, APIs, Digital platforms, Databases, Software systems, E-commerce, EdTech, 3D-printing, Digital fabrication, Automation, Data-driven systems and Technology integration
- **Problem Solving Skills;** I learned that technology development should begin with understanding a problem.
- **Entrepreneurship;** A developer can identify a problem, develop a technological solution, and potentially transform that solution into a business.
- **Communication Skills.**
- **Networking;** Networking is important because it can lead to Mentorship, Collaboration, Internship opportunities, Employment opportunities, Entrepreneurship opportunities and Knowledge sharing

CHALLENGES AND OBSERVATIONS

Although the Innovation Week experience was highly beneficial, I also observed some challenges associated with technology development.

- **Limited Awareness;** Some innovative technologies may not be widely known by potential users. This creates a need for better awareness and technology education.
- **Access to Technology;** Advanced technologies can sometimes be expensive or difficult for some users to access. Therefore, affordability and accessibility are important considerations when developing technology for African markets.
- **Technical Skills;** Technology companies require people with different technical skills. This demonstrates the importance of students continuously developing their skills beyond classroom learning.
- **Sustainability;** Technology products should be designed with long-term sustainability in mind. This includes financial sustainability, technical maintenance, and environmental considerations.

PERSONAL REFLECTION

Participating in Innovation Week Tanzania 2026 was a valuable learning experience for us.

Before attending the event, we mainly understood technology from the perspective of academic learning and programming. However, the experience showed us how technology is transformed into real products and services.

Visiting and learning about organizations such as Neurotech, Ekima Interactive, Vestis Tech, Saratani.AI and Swahili D-Makers exposed us to different areas of technological innovation.

We were able to see how artificial intelligence, software development, digital education, e-commerce, healthcare technology, 3D printing, and digital manufacturing can be used to address real-world challenges.

The experience also made us understand the importance of continuously improving our technical skills.

The event motivated us to think more about how we can use our technical knowledge to develop solutions that can create value in Tanzania and beyond.

CONCLUSION

Innovation Week Tanzania 2026 was an important educational and professional experience.

The five-day participation provided an opportunity to learn about innovation, entrepreneurship, technology and the Tanzanian technology ecosystem.

The exposure to **Neurotech, Ekima Interactive, Vestis Tech, Saratani.AI and Swahili D-Makers** demonstrated the diversity of technological solutions being developed in Tanzania.

The experience helped me understand the practical applications of artificial intelligence, software development, digital learning, e-commerce, healthcare technology, 3D printing, digital fabrication and data-driven systems.

Most importantly, I learned that innovation is not simply about creating new technology. It is about **identifying problems, understanding people, developing effective solutions and creating meaningful value through technology.**

As a Computer Engineering and IT student, the experience strengthened my interest in software development and encouraged me to continue developing my technical, problem-solving, communication and entrepreneurial skills.

Innovation Week Tanzania 2026 therefore contributed significantly to my academic and professional development and provided valuable exposure to the practical world of technology and innovation.